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Stranger Things

How (Not) to Read the Bible · Session 2 · Oct 16, 2026 · @Eric

Video notes

Jot down what stands out as you watch.

A "strange" Old Testament law mentioned in the video:

Where does the law of Moses fit on the Bible's timeline?

Why did God give Israel these laws?

One question the video raised for me:

The method

The Old Testament law was God's good gift to Israel. Christians read it through Jesus, who fulfilled it (Matthew 5:17).

Four questions for any Old Testament law

1. **Who received it, and under which covenant?**
2. **What was it for, then?** Was it about holiness, worship, justice, or care for the vulnerable?
3. **What does the New Testament do with it?** Is it repeated, fulfilled in Christ, or set aside?

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4. **What does it reveal about God's unchanging character,** and how does that truth shape life in Christ?

Question 3 is the key. We don't pick and choose which laws apply. The New Testament shows us.

Workshop

Passage 1: Leviticus 19

Read verses 1–2 aloud. Write the headline of the chapter (v. 2):

Now look up each verse and its New Testament cross-reference. Mark which column it belongs in:

- **R** = **Repeated:** the New Testament restates it
- **F** = **Fulfilled:** Christ fulfilled it, or the New Testament sets it aside
- **C** = **Carried forward:** the principle carries forward in a new form

Leviticus 19	New Testament	R / F / C	What it shows about God
v. 2	1 Peter 1:15–16		
vv. 9–10	Ephesians 4:28		
vv. 11–12	Ephesians 4:25, 28		
v. 18	Mark 12:31		
v. 19	(look for one)		
vv. 21–22	Hebrews 10:10–14		
vv. 27–28	1 Corinthians 6:19–20		
v. 31	Galatians 5:19–21		
v. 32	1 Timothy 5:1–2		
vv. 33–34	Matthew 25:35		

Talk it over: Which placement was hardest to decide? Why?

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Context check on verse 28: Read verses 26–31. What kinds of practices surround the command about cuts and marks?

Passage 2: Mark 7:14–23

Observe

1. What argument started this conversation? (Verses 1–5.)
2. According to Jesus, what can't defile a person? (Verse 15.)
3. What comment does Mark add in verse 19?
4. Where does real defilement come from? (Verses 21–23.)

Interpret

5. If the food laws (Leviticus 11) pointed to something, what were they pointing to?
6. Read Acts 10:9–16, 28. What did Peter learn his vision was really about?
7. Finish the sentence: *The timeless truth here is that God…*

This week

Practice the answer: A friend says, "Christians just pick and choose which verses to follow." How would you respond in two or three sentences?

Take-home practice: Run one of these through the four questions.

- [ ] Deuteronomy 22:8 (build a railing around your roof)
- [ ] Exodus 21:28–29 (the goring ox)
- [ ] Leviticus 11:1–12 (clean and unclean animals)

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Before next week: Read 1 Timothy 2 and 1 Corinthians 14:26–40. Write down any honest questions you have.

"You shall be holy, for I the Lord your God am holy." Leviticus 19:2 (ESV)